European Commission

Match the landmarks the



Each of the 27 EU countries has its own monuments and landmarks. See if you can match the pairs by turning the cards over.

You'll find more about how to print the cards and about the history of each monument or landmark in the following pages.

This is the PDF version of the online game "Match the landmarks", which is available on Learning Corner: **https://europa.eu/learning-corner/match-the-landmarks_en**

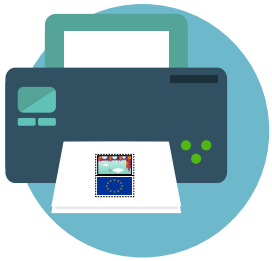




How to prepare the cards

Print the pages containing the EU flags and countries' landmarks.

1



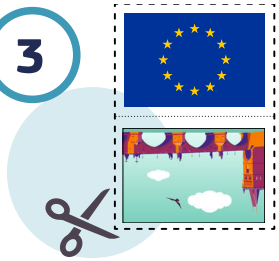
Get a pair of child-friendly scissors, some crayons and paper glue.

2



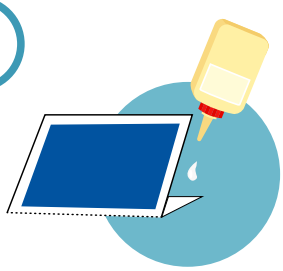
Cut each card along the dotted line.

3



Fold the cards along the dotted line and glue the two sides together.

4



Arrange all the cards with the EU flag facing up and try to match the pairs!

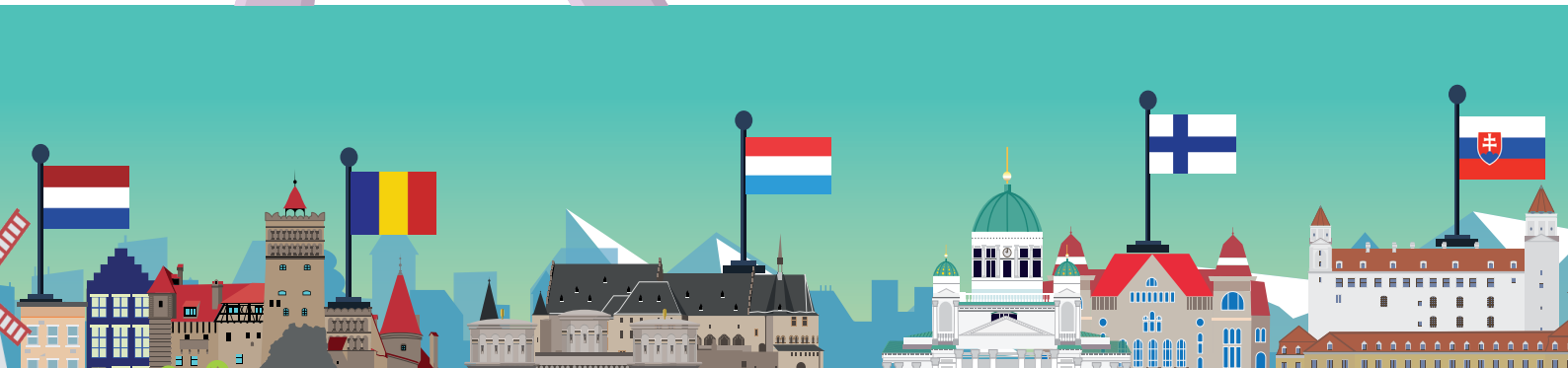
5



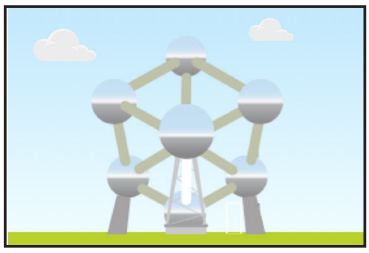
You can find out more about each EU country on pages 12-16.

6



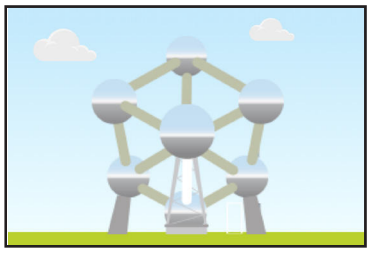


Belgium



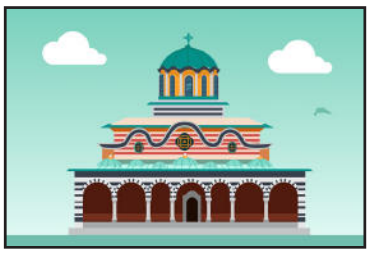


Belgium



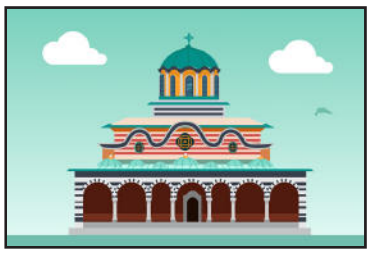


Bulgaria



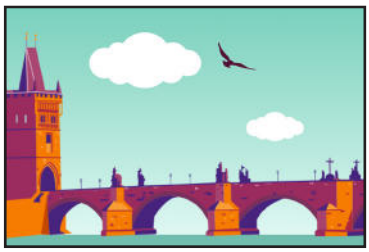


Bulgaria



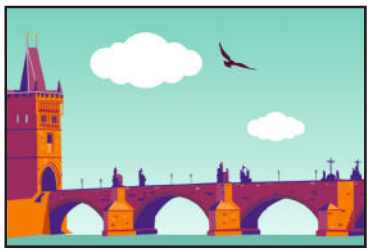


Czechia





Czechia





Denmark



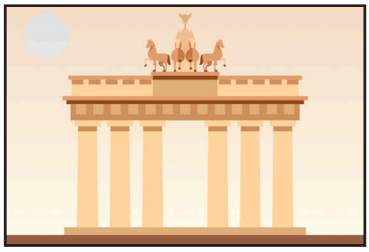


Denmark



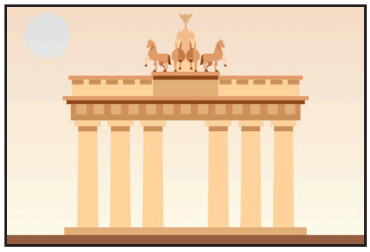


Germany



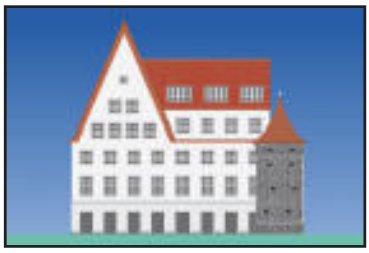


Germany



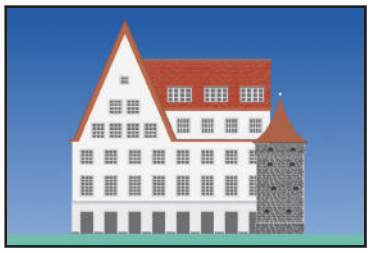


Estonia



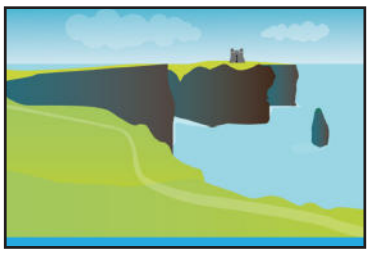


Estonia



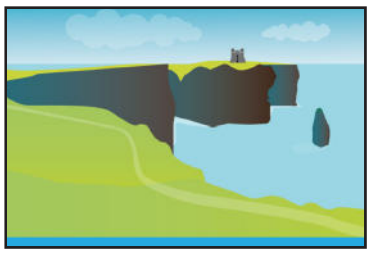


Ireland



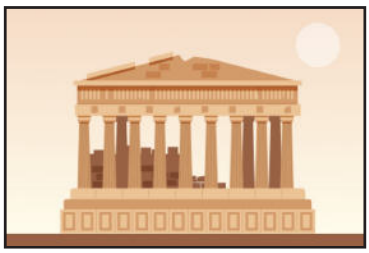


Ireland



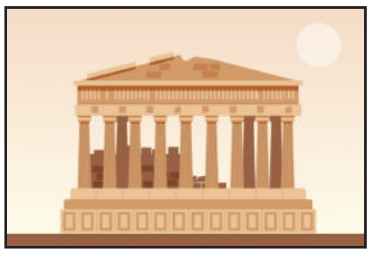


Greece



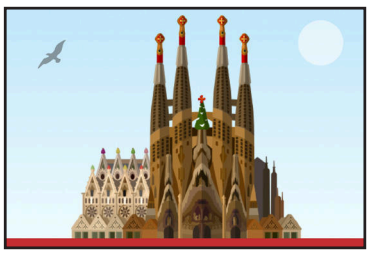


Greece



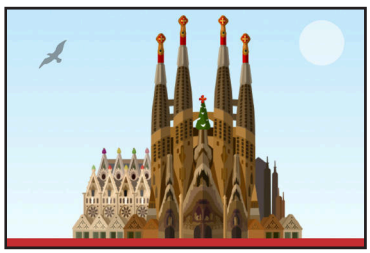


Spain



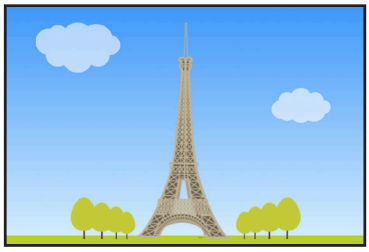


Spain



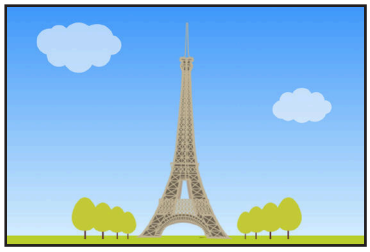


France





France





Croatia



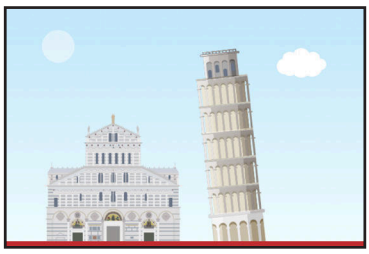


Croatia



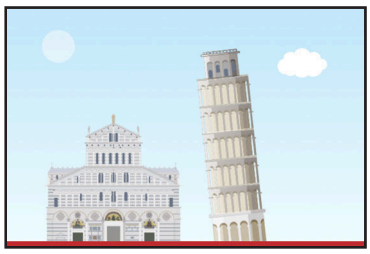


Italy



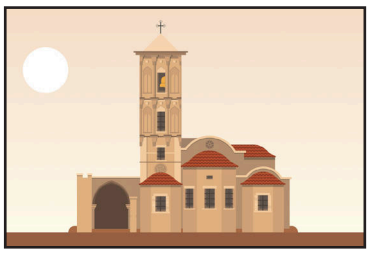


Italy



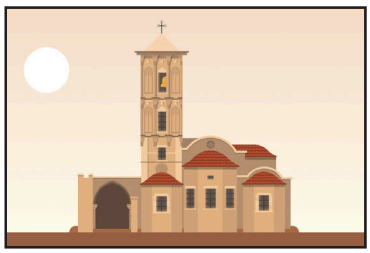


Cyprus



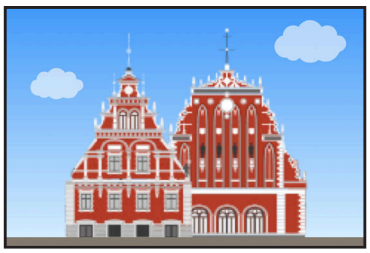


Cyprus



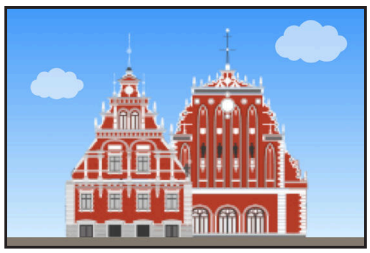


Latvia



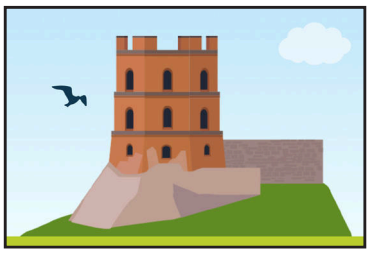


Latvia



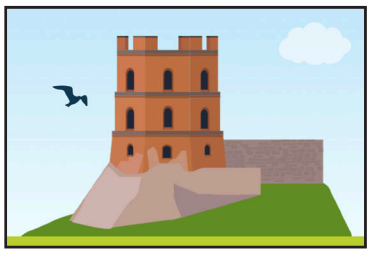


Lithuania



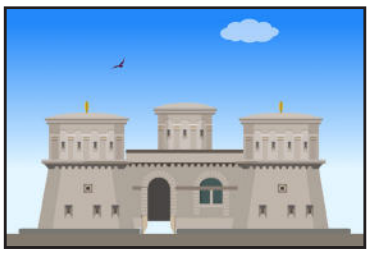


Lithuania



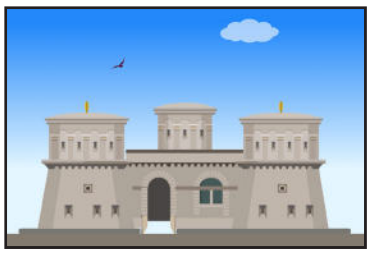


Luxembourg



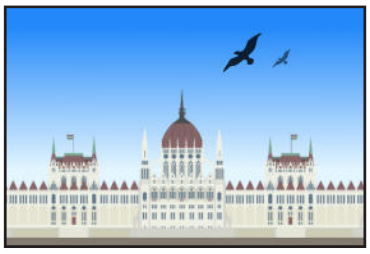


Luxembourg



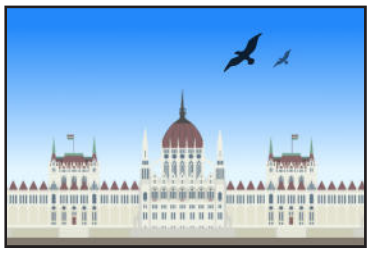


Hungary



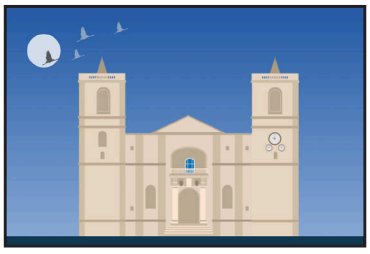


Hungary



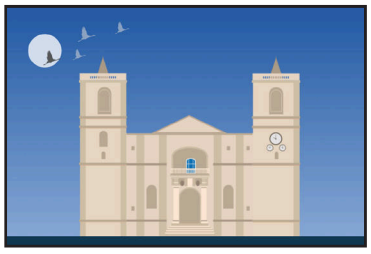


Malta



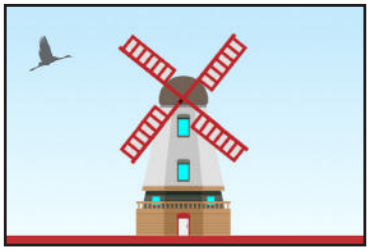


Malta



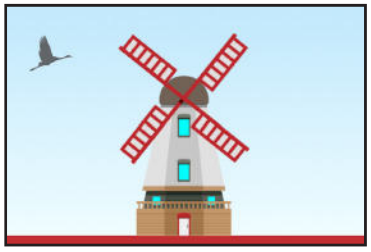


Netherlands



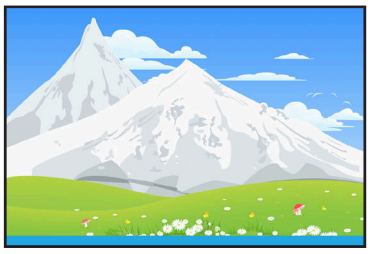


Netherlands



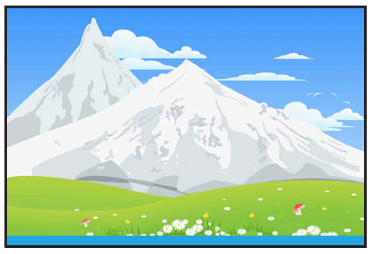


Austria



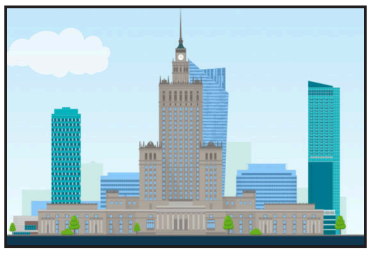


Austria



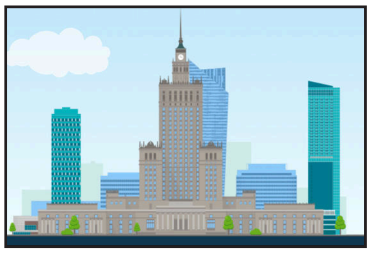


Poland





Poland





Portugal





Portugal





Romania





Romania





Slovenia



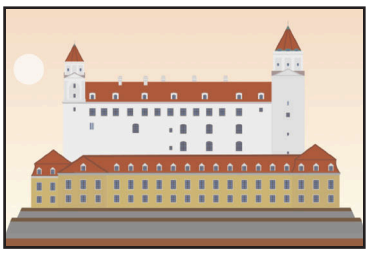


Slovenia



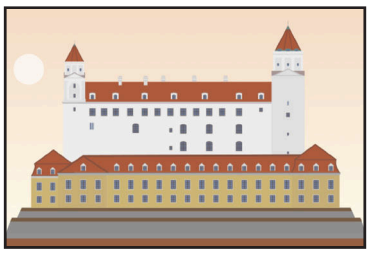


Slovakia



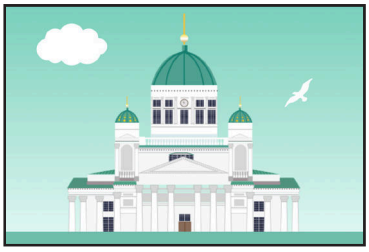


Slovakia



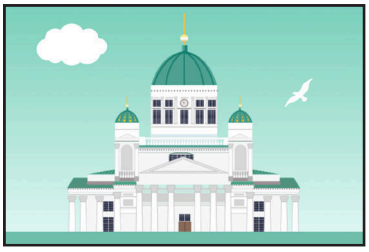


Finland



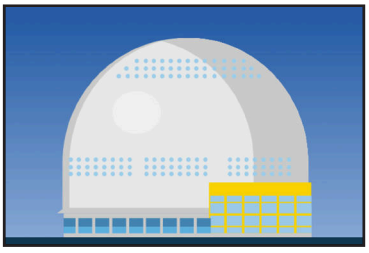


Finland



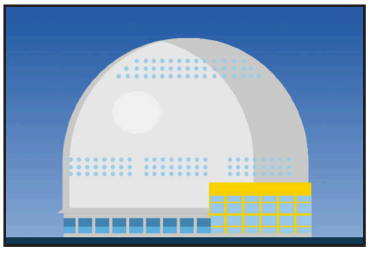


Sweden





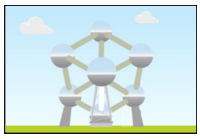
Sweden





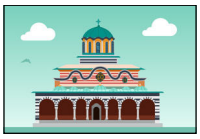


Do you know these places?



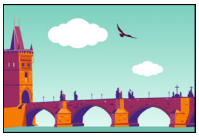
Belgium

This is the 'Atomium'. It was built in 1958 for the World's Fair in Brussels, Belgium's capital city. It shows a molecule of iron but 165 billion times bigger than it really is! It is made up of nine round balls joined together by tubes. You can go inside the balls or zoom up to the top in a lift and look out all over Brussels!



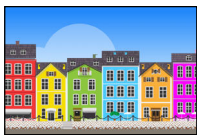
Bulgaria

Do you know what a 'monastery' is? It's a place where 'monks' live and work. Monks worship God, help sick and poor people and look after each other. A famous monastery near Sofia, the capital of Bulgaria, is the 'Rila Monastery' named after a monk called Ivan. He lived on his own, in a cave, hundreds of years ago. Ivan was later made 'Saint Ivan' and many people now visit this monastery named after him.



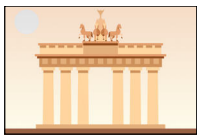
Czechia

King Charles IV ordered the Charles Bridge to be built in 1357 so that the capital city, Prague, would be protected from its enemies. The bridge is 516 metres long and 10 metres wide, with 16 arches and 30 statues of saints. If ever you go to Prague, be sure to look out for the dog in one of the panels on the bridge: rubbing it is said to bring you good luck!



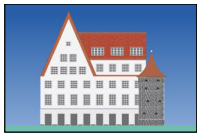
Denmark

This colourful port is called 'Nyhavn', which means 'new port' in Danish, but it is in fact the old port of Denmark's capital city, Copenhagen. The port is full of brightly coloured 17th and early 18th century townhouses, shops, cafés and restaurants, as well as many historical wooden ships.



Germany

Built in 1788, the Brandenburg Gate in Berlin is one of the most famous landmarks in Germany. It was closed in 1961 when the Berlin Wall was built, separating East and West Germany. When the Wall was pulled down in 1989 and the country reunited, it once again became the entry gate to one of the most elegant avenues in the city and a symbol of unity for the country.



Estonia

Tallinn is the capital city of Estonia and its old town is one of the best-preserved in Europe. But Tallinn is also modern. Maybe you have heard of 'Silicon Valley' in California in the United States? It's where companies like Google and Facebook began. Well, Tallinn is often called the 'Silicon Valley of Europe' because there are many computer experts working there.



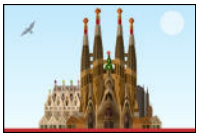
Ireland

The 'Cliffs of Moher' in Ireland's County Clare are a wonder of nature. Stretching out along 14 kilometres, they are visited every year by around 1.5 million people who go there to see the rock formations, plants, birds and other wildlife. Have you seen the film 'Harry Potter and the Half-Blood Prince'? The Cliffs of Moher appear in it....take another look when you next watch it and see if you can spot them!



Greece

The Acropolis is the high rocky hill in Athens, the capital city of Greece, on which many ancient temples were built. They were used as a refuge for the people of Athens if the city was attacked. The Parthenon is the biggest of the temples and was built for 'Athena', the Greek goddess of wisdom. The city of Athens was named after her.



Spain

Work started on building the 'Church of the Sagrada Familia' (Holy Family) in Barcelona in 1882 but was never completed and is still ongoing. It was designed by the famous architect Antoni Gaudí and is expected to be finished in 2026, 100 years after Gaudí's death.



France

The Eiffel Tower in Paris is one of the most famous monuments in the world. It is named after Gustave Eiffel, who built the tower for the World's Fair, which took place in Paris in 1889. Until 1928, when the Chrysler Building in New York was built, the Eiffel Tower was the tallest man-made building in the world.



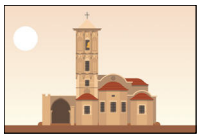
Croatia

The roof of St Mark's Church in Croatia's capital city Zagreb is famous for being very colourful: it shows the 'coat of arms' of the former kingdoms of Croatia, Slavonia and Dalmatia and the coat of arms of Zagreb which is a white castle on a red background. A 'coat of arms' is a picture made up of different designs, sometimes with lions and dragons, and was very popular in the very old days, especially painted on shields when soldiers went to war. Many rich families had their own picture and some people still use them today.



Italy

Pisa is a city in Italy and in 1173 they started building a bell tower. But when the builders got to the second floor, the tower started to sink and lean over. It has stayed like this ever since then! After making sure that the tower will not fall down, visitors are once again allowed to climb the 294 steps to the top of the tower.



Cyprus

The church of Agios Lazarus in Larnaca, Cyprus, was built around 1 200 years ago over the tomb of Saint Lazarus. Lazarus was a man who lived at the same time as Jesus. When Lazarus died, Jesus is said to have brought him back to life again. Later on in his life, Lazarus went to Cyprus and became its first bishop (in charge of the people running the churches) and 'patron saint' (special protector) of Larnaca.



Latvia

This 'House of the Blackheads' stands in the old town of Riga, the capital city of Latvia. It was first built in the 14th century, destroyed in the Second World War and rebuilt in 1995. It is named after a group of unmarried shopkeepers and ship owners who held many feasts and parties there. The tradition of putting up a Christmas tree is said to have begun when Blackheads put up a tree and sang and danced around it during the Christmas period.



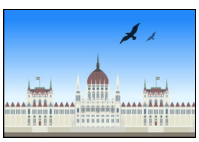
Lithuania

The Gediminas' Tower is the only part still standing of the Upper Castle in Lithuania's capital city, Vilnius. It was finished in 1409. Legend has it that after a day's hunting, Grand Duke Gediminas dreamt that, on top of the hill where he had been hunting, a large iron wolf appeared and started howling like a hundred wolves! When he told this dream to a wizard, he was told that it meant he should build a city there, which would later become a magnificent and world-famous city.



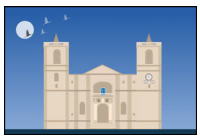
Luxembourg

Built in 1732, Fort Thüngen formed part of the walls around Luxembourg city to protect it from attack. It is also known as 'The Three Acorns' because of the three golden acorns on the top of each tower. The Fort was also surrounded by a deep ditch and could be reached by a long underground rock ditch. Today it is used as a museum.



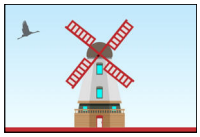
Hungary

This grand building is home to the Hungarian Parliament in Budapest. It stands on the banks of the River Danube, the second longest river in Europe. A 'parliament' is where people meet to talk and decide how to get things done in a country: things like building roads, what to teach in school, taking care of the countryside, for example. It is so big that it took around 100 000 people to build it, using 40 million bricks, half a million precious stones and even 40 kilos of gold!



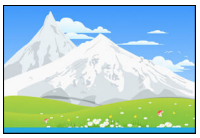
Malta

Opened in 1577, Saint John's Cathedral in the capital city, Valletta, is dedicated to Saint John the Baptist, so-called because he was the man who baptised Jesus Christ. Many scenes inside the Cathedral show the life of Saint John, including on the richly decorated ceiling and the altar.



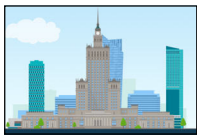
Netherlands

The village of Kinderdijk (meaning 'children's dike') is in the province of South Holland. A dike is something that is built to get back land that would otherwise be underwater, along the sea coast, for example. Around 1740, the Dutch people built these 19 windmills to keep the low-lying lands dry and to prevent the area from flooding.



Austria

Austria has many mountains – most of them in the mountain range called the Alps which is so huge that it also covers parts of other countries. The highest mountain in Austria is called 'Großglockner'. These mountains are covered in snow in the winter so people love to go to Austria to ski!



Poland

At a height of 237m, the 'Palace of Science and Culture' in Poland's capital city, Warsaw, is the tallest building in the country. Built in 1955, it houses theatres, museums and a cinema. In the year 2000, a 'millennium clock' was added to the building. Its second hand is nearly 4 metres long!



Portugal

The 'Belem Tower' is a symbol of the time when Portugal sent out explorers to discover new lands. Built in 1519, it stands on the shores of the River Tagus and was used to protect the capital, Lisbon.



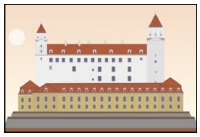
Romania

Located in Transylvania, a region of Romania, Bran Castle is most famous for being 'Count Dracula's castle'. Although the vampire Count only existed in a novel, he was in fact inspired by a real person, Vlad the Impaler, and this castle – which Vlad probably never even visited – looks very much like the description of the castle in the novel.



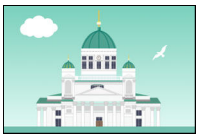
Slovenia

Lake Bled, in the northwestern part of Slovenia, is a very popular tourist destination. There are several buildings on the island in the lake but the most visited is the 'Assumption of Mary' church. It is considered to bring good luck to a newly-married couple if the new husband carries his bride up the 99 stone steps of the church tower.



Slovakia

Standing on a hill high above the River Danube, Bratislava Castle dates from the 9th century. Over the years, it has had lots of alterations and was even damaged by a huge fire in 1811. The castle has four wings, each one with a tower on top. At one time, the Hungarian crown jewels were kept in the south-west tower .That's because Slovakia used to be ruled by the Hungarians for a while.



Finland

Helsinki's cathedral with its tall, green dome and four smaller domes has become the symbol of the city. It is also a landmark for those arriving by sea. It was built in 1852 as a tribute to Tsar Nicholas when Finland was part of Russia.



Sweden

Shaped like a huge golf ball, the Ericsson Globe is the largest hemispherical (meaning 'half ball-shaped') building in the world. Opened in 1989, it is an indoor arena used to house ice hockey tournaments, shows and rock concerts. At night, it is lit up and can be seen for miles!